section of the book as part of my discussion on creation of tribal identities by the coloniser in Bharat, the working definition of the Martinez Cobo Study, among other things, has the effect of negating the precolonial histories of countries like Bharat. Given that Cobo's definition was formulated in 1986-1987, that is, before Quijano's formulation of coloniality (in 1989), the application of the decolonial option to Cobo's definition is imperative. Critically, international instruments on indigenous peoples and their issues continue to build on the Cartesian subject–object relationship by treating 'indigenous peoples' and 'dominant majority populations' as communities that are destined to live in walled gardens for eternity with the 'indigenous tribes' forming the objects of study.

This silo-based colonial approach to indigeneity has not changed despite the adoption of the United Nations Declaration of the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP)[27] by 144 countries in September 2007, which was voted against by the United States of America, Canada, Australia and New Zealand, and abstained from by 11 countries, namely Azerbaijan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, Burundi, Colombia, Georgia, Kenya, Nigeria, the Russian Federation, Samoa and Ukraine. The rights enumerated in the declaration 'constitute the minimum standards for the survival, dignity and well-being of the Indigenous Peoples of the world'.[28] Ostensibly, the declaration protects both collective rights and individual rights of indigenous peoples in matters of self-government, land, education, employment, health and other areas, which is essentially a Europeanisation of indigenous issues because the central issue of mainstreaming the indigenous consciousness remains untouched. However, the silver lining is that the declaration does not define indigenous peoples or spell out the parameters for their identification, giving former colonies the chance to break from colonial stereotypes and metrics. In other words, the absence of a universal definition, although unintentionally decolonial, provides a pluriversal window to former colonies to address issues of indigeneity.

Then again, the declaration also makes it clear that there is a significant room for 'international' intervention so that member States are 'encouraged to comply with and effectively implement all their obligations as they apply to indigenous peoples under international instruments'. It says: 'The rights affirmed in treaties, agreements and other constructive arrangements between States and indigenous peoples are, in some situations, matters of international concern, interest, responsibility and character.' Clearly, these